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To Foreign Shores: From Regimental Centre to the IPKF

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En route to Fatehgarh from Ferozepur, I halted at Delhi during my joining period to spend time with Veena who was well along in her pregnancy, with the baby due in March. Veena was the epitome of discipline; proper meals, no late nights and an hour's walk every evening without fail. It was good to be with Veena, not having been with her ever since she left Binaguri. Although I could not be present, I was not worried since Veena was with her mother Rita, who was herself very grounded and a no-nonsense type. My father-in-law, Shridhar Kaka as I called him, was there too, a gentle soul, who without interfering, was always present. Someone you could bank on. All too soon it was time to leave for Fatehgarh. I was not sure whether after joining in the second half of February, that too after the Ex Brasstacks delay, I would get leave in March, within a month of joining the new assignment. Rita told me not to worry and that she would keep me informed of all developments. I caught the Kalindi Express from Old Delhi Railway Station, bound for

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